GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

Ministry of Minority Affairs

Promoting Inclusion, Opportunity, and Social Empowerment

Confidential and Proprietory

August 2026

SHRI NARENDRA MODI

HONORABLE PRIME MINISTER, INDIA



MESSAGE

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SHRI KIREN RIJIJU

HONORABLE MINISTER,

MINISTRY OF MINORITY AFFAIRS



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SHRI MUNINDRA KUMAR

DIRECTOR GENERAL, CHAMBER OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRIES OF INDIA



MESSAGE

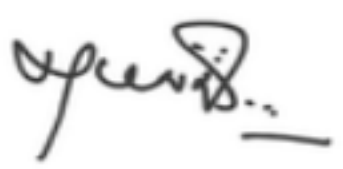
Inclusive development remains one of the defining pillars of India's growth journey. The Ministry of Minority Affairs plays an important role in empowering minority communities through education, skill development, entrepreneurship, economic participation, social inclusion, and institutional support. By creating opportunities for equitable growth, the Ministry contributes significantly to strengthening the nation's social and economic fabric.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI India) believes that inclusive economic participation is essential for achieving sustainable national development. Through policy advocacy, entrepreneurship promotion, skill enhancement, investment facilitation, startup support, market access initiatives, and industry partnerships, CCI India remains committed to supporting the Ministry's efforts in expanding opportunities for minority entrepreneurs, youth, women, artisans, and professionals.

This Knowledge Paper presents a comprehensive overview of the Ministry's strategic priorities, flagship programmes, policy framework, institutional initiatives, and emerging opportunities that can accelerate socio-economic empowerment. It explores collaborative approaches across education, entrepreneurship, financial inclusion, digital literacy, capacity building, innovation, employment generation, and community development.

The publication is intended to serve as a strategic reference for policymakers, educational institutions, financial organizations, entrepreneurs, investors, civil society organizations, industry leaders, and development agencies committed to advancing inclusive growth. Through stronger partnerships and knowledge sharing, it seeks to promote economic participation, institutional strengthening, and sustainable livelihood opportunities.

As India progresses towards becoming a more inclusive and prosperous nation, empowering every section of society will remain central to long-term development. CCI India looks forward to working alongside the Ministry of Minority Affairs in creating opportunities that foster social equity, economic empowerment, and national progress.



Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

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PREFACE

India's ambition to emerge as a USD 30 trillion economy by 2047 articulated through the vision of Viksit Bharat rests critically upon the active participation of every segment of its diverse citizenry. Among these, six constitutionally recognised minority communities Muslims, Christians, Sikhs, Buddhists, Jains, and Zoroastrians constitute approximately 19.7 percent of the national population, representing over 290 million individuals whose full socioeconomic integration remains both a moral imperative and a developmental necessity.

The Ministry of Minority Affairs, established in 2006 as a dedicated institutional mechanism of the Union Government, carries the constitutional and statutory mandate to design, coordinate, implement, evaluate, and scale welfare and development programmes for these communities. It operates at the confluence of education, skill development, economic inclusion, infrastructure, cultural preservation, and social empowerment making it one of the most multi-dimensional ministries within the Government of India's cabinet structure.

This Knowledge Paper has been commissioned and prepared by the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India (CCI India) as a high-quality strategic advisory document intended to map the Ministry's mandate, institutional structure, programmatic landscape, and strategic opportunities in a manner suitable for engagement with Union Ministers, Secretaries to the Government of India, NITI Aayog, senior bureaucrats, industry leaders, domestic and international investors, and multilateral development institutions.

The paper draws upon publicly available government data, Sachar Committee findings, Ministry annual reports, Union Budget allocations, NITI Aayog assessments, World Bank development indicators, and comparative international benchmarks. It adopts a consulting-grade analytical framework identifying gaps, assessing opportunities, designing collaboration models, and proposing a five-year strategic roadmap with the explicit purpose of positioning CCI India as a credible, institutional, and results-oriented strategic partner for the Ministry of Minority Affairs.

CCI India's vision is straightforward: to translate the Government's inclusive development agenda into tangible, measurable, on-ground outcomes by bridging the structural distance between state policy intent and market-driven execution. Through its national industry network, investor relationships, startup ecosystem access, research capabilities, and public-private partnership expertise, CCI India is uniquely positioned to serve as the connective tissue between the Ministry and the broader economic ecosystem of India.

This Knowledge Paper is structured across twenty-one sections, progressing from foundational context through current landscape analysis, gap identification, opportunity mapping, and a detailed five-year collaborative roadmap. It is intended to serve as a living strategic document one that informs, persuades, and operationalises a transformative partnership between the Government of India's minority welfare architecture and India's organised private sector.

Chamber of Commerce and Industry (CCI India)

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About CCI India

CCI India (The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India) is a premier national business chamber dedicated to fostering economic growth, industry development, entrepreneurship, innovation, and investment promotion across India. As the voice of Indian business and industry, CCI India serves as a bridge between government, industry, startups, academia, investors, and civil society, facilitating meaningful collaboration for nation-building and sustainable development.

Through policy advocacy, business facilitation, research, stakeholder engagement, capacity building, and strategic partnerships, CCI India works to create an enabling environment for enterprises of all sizes. The Chamber actively supports key national initiatives such as Startup India, Make in India, Digital India, Atmanirbhar Bharat, Skill India, and Viksit Bharat 2047 by connecting innovative enterprises with government opportunities and promoting inclusive economic development.

CCI India operates through sector-specific councils, industry forums, knowledge platforms, and state-level engagements that address emerging opportunities and challenges across sectors including manufacturing, agriculture, technology, healthcare, education, infrastructure, sustainability, MSMEs, and startups. The Chamber regularly organizes policy dialogues, investment summits, business delegations, workshops, conferences, and knowledge-sharing initiatives to strengthen India's economic ecosystem.

With a strong commitment to innovation, entrepreneurship, and public-private collaboration, CCI India strives to empower enterprises, facilitate investment, enhance competitiveness, and contribute to India's journey toward becoming a globally competitive and economically resilient nation. Its role as a knowledge partner and industry catalyst enables ministries, departments, state governments, startups, and businesses to collaborate effectively in achieving national development objectives.

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1. INTRODUCTION TO THE MINISTRY OF MINORITY AFFAIRS

1.1 Constitutional & Statutory Mandate

The Ministry of Minority Affairs was carved out of the erstwhile Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment on 29 January 2006, following the acceptance of the Sachar Committee's interim recommendations and the Government's resolve to provide a dedicated, focused institutional mechanism for the welfare of India's religious minority communities. The Ministry derives its mandate from Articles 15, 16, 25–30, and 46 of the Constitution of India, which collectively prohibit discrimination on grounds of religion, guarantee freedom of religion, protect minority rights to establish and administer educational institutions, and direct the State to promote the economic and educational interests of weaker sections with special attention to minorities.

Operationally, the Ministry functions under the National Commission for Minorities Act, 1992; the National Commission for Minority Educational Institutions Act, 2004; and the Waqf Act, 1995 (amended 2013). These legislative instruments define the boundaries of its jurisdiction from monitoring the welfare of notified minorities to regulating minority educational institutions and overseeing Waqf property management, which collectively constitutes one of India's largest institutional land-holding portfolios.

1.2 Governance Architecture and National Significance

The Ministry's governance architecture is simultaneously normative and operational. On the normative side, it advises Parliament and the Cabinet on policy frameworks pertaining to minority welfare, facilitating inter-ministerial coordination with Ministries of Education, Skill Development, Housing, MSME, and Finance. On the operational side, it directly administers flagship schemes such as PM Jan Vikas Karyakram (PMJVK), SEEKHO AUR KAMAO (Learn and Earn), NAYE MANZIL, NISHTHA (now USTTAD), and the Pre- and Post-Matric Scholarship programmes delivering welfare services to millions of beneficiaries annually.

The national significance of the Ministry extends beyond welfare delivery to encompass social cohesion, political stability, and India's international reputation as a pluralistic democracy. Minority communities contribute disproportionately to certain high-value sectors including artisan crafts, handloom and textile manufacturing, small-scale food processing, informal construction, and trade sectors that generate substantial export revenues and employment. Institutional neglect of these communities therefore creates direct economic inefficiencies in addition to social inequities.

1.3 Evolving Governance Role

Over the period 2006–2026, the Ministry has transitioned from a primarily welfare-disbursement orientation towards a more development-oriented, outcomes-focused approach. The shift is reflected in the evolution of its flagship schemes from community-area infrastructure grants under MSDP (Multi-Sectoral Development Programme) to the integrated PMJVK framework that seeks to align minority welfare with SDG outcomes, national infrastructure development, and skill ecosystem building. This institutional evolution positions the Ministry as a potential co-architect of India's inclusive growth narrative rather than merely a welfare dispatcher.

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